



REAL
Saturday

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Real News in Real Time

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Can tables turn?

...UPND Presidential candidate leads with over 81,000 votes in 27 constituencies so far

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MoE warns against boarding school bullying

By Alex Maboshe

The Ministry of Education has expressed concern over reports of bullying, intimidation, theft and other misconduct in secondary boarding schools.

In a statement issued today, Permanent Secretary for Educational Services Dr Kelvin Mambwe warned that such behaviour has no place in the country's education system, as it undermines the safety, dignity, wellbeing and academic development of learners.

The ministry noted a video circulating on social media showing a boy being assaulted by a fellow learner at a school in February this year.

The incident is currently being handled by the school authorities.

"Schools must be places where every learner feels safe, respected, protected and supported," Dr Mambwe said.

"Bullying; whether physical, verbal, psychological, sexual, social or online will not be tolerated. Theft of learners' belongings or school property is equally unacceptable."

He called on school administrators, teachers, staff, parents, guardians and learners to work together to prevent and address these challenges.



ECZ Chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis during the announcement of Presidential Election Results in Lusaka today

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Real News in Real Time

Tiye P drops “Ballot Box Blues”



By Alex Maboshe

Zambian hip-hop veteran Tiye P born Jonathan Nyirenda has released a sharp new single titled “Ballot Box Blues,” a track that blends hard-hitting bars

with pointed observations on politics, power, and the everyday struggles of ordinary citizens.

The song, which arrived a day before polling day this week, finds the longtime Lusaka MC shifting from the

street anthems and collaborative cyphers he’s known for into more socially conscious territory.

Over a gritty, mid-tempo beat heavy on booming drums and sparse synths, Tiye P delivers rapid-fire verses that

reference election cycles, unfulfilled promises, and the gap between political rhetoric and lived reality on the ground.

The chorus sticks in the head with a memorable, chant-like hook that has already begun circulating in fan clips and WhatsApp status updates.

Early reactions on social media praise the track’s clarity and timing, with many calling it one of Tiye P’s most direct statements yet.

“He didn’t hold back,” one listener posted. “This is the Tiye P we need right now.”

Others have highlighted the clever wordplay and the way the production leaves space for his distinctive flow to cut through.

The single arrives amid a busy period for the artist, who has remained a consistent presence on features and cyphers in recent years, including appearances on projects alongside names like Dizmo, Jay Rox, and various end-of-year collective tracks.

While Tiye P has never shied away from speaking his mind in interviews and earlier material, “Ballot Box Blues” marks one of his clearest forays into political commentary in song form.

Whether “Ballot Box Blues” becomes a lasting anthem or simply a timely snapshot of the moment, Tiye P has once again reminded listeners why he remains a respected voice in Zambian hip-hop—one unafraid to put the mic where the conversation is.

Drifta Trek in love?



By Alex Maboshe

Zambian hip-hop heavy-weight Drifta Trek born Njavwanji Sinkala is keeping the momentum going with the release of his fresh love-themed single “Plus One,” featuring the smooth vocals of rising singer Frank Ro.

The track, which landed three days ago accompanied with a colourful music video, serves as the latest preview of Trek’s highly anticipated studio album Unfinished Business.

Known for his sharp Nyanja flows, street-conscious lyricism, and consistent output including recent cuts like “Mudala” with Chester and Chef 187, Drifta Trek shifts into a more romantic lane here.

“Plus One” blends his signature hip-hop energy with Frank Ro’s melodic, soulful delivery, creating a catchy, feel-good anthem centered on love and companionship.

Frank Ro, the Kabwe-born artist celebrated for hits like “Sotambe” and a string of Afro-fusion and R&B-tinged tracks, brings the perfect complementary vibe.

His polished singing style has made him a go-to collaborator in the Zambian scene, and the chemistry with Trek shines through on this one.

Fans and local music blogs have already taken notice.

The single is available for streaming and download across platforms.

Unfinished Business is expected to further showcase his range, and “Plus One” suggests the album will balance gritty storytelling with more accessible, radio-friendly moments.

With “Plus One” now out, the Fire Department, Trek’s dedicated fanbase is locked in and waiting for the full body of work.

Keep the election process lawful, peaceful-CSOs

By Linda Nyondo

Civil society leaders have urged politicians and security forces to keep the election process peaceful and strictly within the law,

warning that inflammatory language or unlawful action could undermine confidence in the vote.

Linda Kasonde, a spokesperson for the group, said rhetoric from political actors can either reassure the public or provoke suspicion and unrest.

“State action involving a presidential candidate, political actor or their supporters during an election must be demonstrably lawful,” she said.

The organisation expressed concern about what it described as the alleged use of military force in handling politically charged incidents amid an unresolved election, saying it risks militarizing a civilian democratic process.

They cited the reported alleged detention of opposition leader Brian Mundubile, former Law Association of Zambia president George Chisanga, other politicians and supporters.

The group urged security officers to ensure all actions remain within the confines

of the law and said everyone accused of an offence must be allowed legal representation.

“All actions undertaken must be constitutionally authorised,” Ms Kasonde added. She appealed to Zambians to rise above partisan politics and place the nation’s interest first by upholding peace and unity.

“There will be winners, and there will also be those who will not win. Zambia and Zambians are bigger than any political party, candidate or individual,” she said.

Ms Kasonde also warned against spreading rumours and inciting violence. The group called on the Electoral Commission of Zambia to speed up and fully publish election results, saying delays create unnecessary tension and anxiety.

She stressed the need for transparency from the ECZ. “Elections determine who governs; they must not determine whether we remain one people,” she said.

Prepare 2 speeches - Nevers

By Alex Maboshe

Former Vice President Nevers Mumba has urged all presidential candidates to prepare two speeches ahead of the declaration of the 2026 presidential election results – one to celebrate victory and another to concede defeat.

Speaking live on his Facebook page, Dr Mumba said the way a candidate handles defeat would reveal the kind of leader they truly are.

“I would like to advise all candidates, and it is important that you write two speeches; one to celebrate and accept your victory if you win. The other speech is to concede defeat when you lose,” he said.

He stressed that losing an election does not equal rejection but simply a postponement of a candidate’s leadership ambitions to a later time.

Dr Mumba specifically called on both President Hakainde Hichilema and Brian Mundubile to prepare speeches for either outcome. “Write two speeches. Don’t write one of victory,” he emphasised.

He further appealed to Zambians to remain calm, unite and allow the Electoral Commission of Zambia to carry out its duties without interference.

“Why don’t we unite as a people? Why don’t we hold hands together? Why don’t we trust the process? Why don’t we believe in the institutions we have created for ourselves?” Dr Mumba asked.

Can tables turn?

By Ruth Kambita

United Party for National Development (UPND) Presidential candidate Hakainde Hichilema has maintained a comfortable and growing lead over his closest rival, Brian Mundubile of the National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP), in this year’s general election results.

This is out of 27 constituencies counted out of the 226 continuances, leaving a question whether the lead could at some point be overturned as the counting progresses.

Although Mr Hichilema trails Mr Mundubile in some

constituencies, his vote totals in those areas remain consistently above 1,000. By contrast, Mr Mundubile has recorded fewer than 100 votes in several constituencies where Mr Hichilema has secured as many as 22,000.

If this trend continues, President Hichilema may retain his seat, although not without contest: Mr Mundubile’s team has already expressed dissatisfaction with the results readout so far by the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ).

At one point, three representatives from the opposition Tonse Alliance were asked to keep silent or were escorted out by security after inter-

rupting the announcement, claiming they had not been consulted and wished to verify the correctness of the results.

ECZ Chairperson Mwan-gala Zaloumis dismissed their objections, saying they were raising concerns at an inappropriate time.

Ms Zaloumis clarified that results are verified by constituency agents before announcement. Despite tensions, the session continued with commissioners presenting the official vote counts and turnout percentages for each region.

After the announcement, Tonse Alliance representative Roosevelt Tonga expressed

deep distrust in the ECZ’s procedures, describing the electoral process as questionable amid ongoing uncertainty and a lack of clarity.

Bishop John Lungu, Public Relations Director of the Apostles’ Council of Churches, condemned the unauthorised interruption and the unsanctioned use of a microphone during the proceedings, calling such behaviour unwarranted and damaging to civic order.

Dr Lungu stressed the importance of allowing the electoral commission to carry out its legal mandate without interference.

He urged politicians and

party members to remain sober, exercise patience and prioritise peace to prevent national unrest, and called on citizens to uphold the law and maintain stability throughout the electoral process.

Following the data presentation, the Chief Electoral Officer announced that this constituted the first set of updates. A second set of results is scheduled for release at 21:00 this evening.

The results centre has been generally peaceful, though some stakeholders were heard complaining and raising concerns after the announcements.

Let's restore calm and wait!



By Dr Orleans Mfuné

As official results continue to pour in, many Zambians are on the edge. A brief suspension of the counting and announcement of results, social media reports of violence and stolen marked ballots are all adding to a tense atmosphere that is unsettling our people.

As a nation, we did right on the polling day. We exercised our civic duty peacefully, side by side, all for the future of our great country.

We expected the same calm that characterized the voting day to continue. But that calm has been tested and rattled by unpleasant reports of violence, accusations and counter accusations, albeit some unverified.

As we still have many hours to go before the final results declaration, it is important that we reflect on this situation. We need, in my view, to restore calm and peacefully wait for the results. There is absolutely no need for violent reactions.

Often, problems of this nature arise when people see elections as a matter of life and death. When we see it that way, we lose sight of the essence of elections as a process for national building and selecting a team of leaders that will steer our nation and communities into the future.

Simply put, elections are about the future of the country and our communities and not the future of political individuals or groups of politicians. Individuals who decide to have their names on the ballot do so voluntarily knowing that an election can only have two outcomes - a win or a loss. Moreover, unlike voting, which is a right, winning is not.

When individuals and their supporters see winning as a right or a moral necessity, then problems emerge, as they try to get their way at all cost. Thus, manipulations and violent reactions become inevitable. In the process, it is

the same citizens that politicians are supposed to serve that get hurt.

As an independent observer, let me appeal to our politicians and their supporters. For the love of the nation and the people, help to keep the peace. It is the most important resource we have as a nation and we should not trade it for anything! Remember that elections come and go. This one is passed and if you did not get a win, there is still another chance in 2031.

To our social media commentators, we know you keep us informed and some of you are reacting to the situation on the ground but we need you to act responsibly. Do not post unverified alarming information, hate speech or anything that encourages violence. Always have the nation in mind as you make the post.

For supporters of political parties or independents, always verify the information you receive, whether through social media or other third parties. Do not be quick to react and avoid being used as instruments of violence or intimidations at all cost. Live to see another election! Remember, keeping the peace is for all of us.



The duly elected member of parliament for Mongu East Constituency Mubita Nawa thank the people of Mongu East for their support today at sefula secondary school

INEQUALITY: A JUSTICE PERSPECTIVE

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By Darlington Chiluba

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The wait is over



TV Analysis

By Sam Phiri

After a spectacular 2026 FIFA World Cup, European football returns with a bang as SuperSport on DStv and GOtv presents comprehensive coverage to launch the 2026/27 season. From showcase showpieces to the opening

rounds of Europe's leading leagues, viewers can expect non-stop elite football in the weeks ahead.

The campaign opens in style with the UEFA Super Cup as Paris Saint-Germain bid to extend their continental dominance. Having secured successive UEFA Champions League titles, PSG will seek back-to-back Super Cup triumphs, but they face a resolute Aston Villa side that has grown in stature on the European stage. The tie pairs continental pedigree with fresh ambition and provides a fitting prelude to the season.

Attention then turns to the traditional English curtain-raiser, the FA Community Shield, staged in Cardiff. Premier League champions Arsenal meet FA Cup winners Manchester City in a heavyweight encounter that offers an early indicator of the balance of power in England. For City, it heralds the start of a new era under Enzo Maresca; for Arsenal, it is an opportunity to reinforce their status as the side to beat. Expect intensity, quality and clear statements of intent from both camps.

La Liga's opening fixtures offer an early glimpse of form in Spain. With Real Madrid, Barcelona and Atletico Madrid afforded extra recovery time following Spain's World Cup success, the spotlight initially falls on the remainder of the division to seize early momentum. Emerging challengers and

established pretenders will look to impose themselves before the big three rejoin the fray.

The Premier League also bursts back into life. Champions Arsenal begin their title defence at home to promoted Coventry in a fixture that encapsulates English football's blend of aspiration and expectation. Across the opening weekend there will be historic rivalries, new narratives and managerial storylines ensuring drama from the first whistle.

Italy's Serie A adds further quality to an already packed schedule. Inter Milan start the defence of their Scudetto against Monza, intent on carrying forward last season's form. With traditional powerhouses and hungry challengers in contention, the Italian top flight promises tactical nuance and high-stakes competition.

From Paris to Cardiff and across Spain, England and Italy, the new European season arrives brimming with excitement. SuperSport on DStv and GOtv is your destination for every pass, tackle and goal — comprehensive live coverage so nothing is missed. The game is back; let the season begin.

Broadcast details (all times CAT) and channel listings are available on the SuperSport schedule.

FAZ
Transition
League
season
kick-off
deferred to
October

By Benedict Tembo

Zambia's revised football calendar to initially run under a transitional set up, will now kick-off in October with Super League teams divided into two streams, 'A' and 'B'.

The Transitional League which will pave way for a permanent set up in 2027, will now kick-off on October 3 with the two streams running side by side.

Initially scheduled to start on September 16, 2026, the Transitional League season will close in January and facilitate the switch to the old league format which ran from March to December every year.

The opening fixtures will see some of the country's biggest clubs going head-to-head across the two streams.

Kitwe giants Power Dynamos will launch their title defence away to Konkola Blades in Stream 'A' while Red Arrows visit Mutondo Stars on their Match Day One opener in the 'B' Stream.

Promotion side Triden will open their campaign at Sentinel Ground against Nkanawitg Makeni All Stars hosting Kansanshi at the Reiz Arena, formerly Woodlands stadium in Lusaka.

There will also be mouth watering encounters for other Super League upstarts, Roan United and Chirundu United.

While Roan return to the BiG League with a visit to Nkwazi, Chirundu will be away to Green Buffaloes.

Under the Transitional League format, the season will run from October 3, 2026 to January 24, 2027, forming part of the transition as FAZ moves towards the restored football calendar.

The competition will see the winner of Stream 'A' meeting the winner of Stream 'B' in a decisive final.

The winner of that final will be crowned the MTN Transitional League champion.

STREAM 'A'
Konkola Blades vs Power Dynamos (Konkola Stadium).
NAPSA Stars vs MUZA FC (Reiz Arena).

Nchanga Rangers vs Zanaco (Nchanga Stadium).
Trident FC vs Nkana FC (Sentinel Ground).
Makeni All Stars vs Kansanshi Dynamos (Reiz Arena).

STREAM 'B'
Kabwe Warriors vs ZESCO United (Railway Stadium).
Mufulira Wanderers vs Green Eagles (Shinde Stadium).
Nkwazi vs Roan United (Edwin Imboela Stadium).
Mutondo Stars vs Red Arrows (Kafubu Stadium).
Green Buffaloes vs Chirundu United (Edwin Imboela Stadium).

Sporting Lusaka duo Sibene, Banda
join Swedish club IFK Stocksund



Robert Banda (right)

James Nene (right)

By Benedict Tembo

TWO Zambian teenage internationals James Sibeene and Robert Banda have joined Swedish side IFK Stocksund.

Sibeene and Banda from Sporting Lusaka Academy have been attending trials in Sweden before putting pen to paper this week.

The duo who are 18-years-old, were with the Zambia Under-17 national team at the FIFA World Cup in Doha where Sibeene was the vice-captain.

Sibeene started all COSAFA, CAF Under-17 Africa Cup of Nations and World Cup

matches for Zambia.

"We can confirm that academy graduate Robert Banda has joined Swedish side IFK Stocksund on loan. A proud moment for Sporting Lusaka and Zambian football as two young players take the next step in their careers. A new chapter begins in Scandinavia," Sporting Lusaka said on their Facebook page.

Sporting Lusaka say that Sibeene, known as "Nene", and Banda, affectionately called "Sugar Sugar," are both highly-rated young talents who will be looking to make their mark in Sweden.

"A new challenge in Scandinavia awaits

the highly-rated midfielder. We hope that James continues to lead from the front in his time at IFK Stocksund and are excited to follow his future development," Sporting Lusaka, aka the TheGlamourBoys said.

Sporting Lusaka campaign in Division Two and have been placed in Stream 'B' of the Lusaka Province League.

Stream 'B' comprises Happy Hearts, Irwin Rangers, Kamaila, Lusaka City Council, Game On, Morkverd Sports Klubb, Red Lions, Shamuel Academy and Young Crocs.

The duo join a growing list of Zambian internationals who are plying their careers across Europe.